

Northwind Robotics

1. Company Overview

Northwind Robotics was founded in 2016 and is headquartered in Austin, Texas, with a satellite engineering office in Pune, India. The company designs and manufactures autonomous warehouse robots used by mid-size logistics providers. As of the most recent fiscal year, Northwind Robotics employs 340 people across engineering, sales, operations, and customer support. The company's mission statement is "to make warehouse automation affordable for businesses that were previously priced out of robotics." Northwind Robotics is a private company and has not filed for an IPO as of this handbook's publication date.

2. Work Hours and Remote Work Policy

Standard working hours are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour unpaid lunch break. Employees are expected to be online and reachable during core hours of 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM local time. Northwind Robotics operates a hybrid work model: employees are required to work from the office a minimum of 2 days per week, with Tuesday designated as a mandatory in-office day for all teams. Fully remote work arrangements must be approved in writing by both the employee's manager and the VP of People Operations, and are re-evaluated every 6 months. Employees working from outside their home country for more than 30 consecutive days must notify the People Operations team in advance for tax and compliance reasons.

3. Paid Time Off (PTO) and Leave Policy

Full-time employees accrue 18 days of paid time off (PTO) per calendar year, accrued at a rate of 1.5 days per completed month of employment. PTO can be carried over into the following year up to a maximum of 5 unused days; anything beyond that is forfeited on December 31st unless local law requires otherwise. New employees become eligible to use accrued PTO after completing a 90-day probationary period. Northwind Robotics also provides 10 paid holidays per year, published annually by People Operations. Parental leave is 16 weeks fully paid for the primary caregiver and 6 weeks fully paid for the secondary caregiver, regardless of gender, and can be taken within 12 months of the birth or adoption. Employees requesting PTO of 5 or more consecutive days must submit the request at least 14 days in advance for manager approval.

4. Health and Wellness Benefits

Northwind Robotics covers 100% of the employee's health insurance premium

and 70% of the premium for dependents under the company's PPO health plan. Employees become eligible for health benefits on their first day of employment; there is no waiting period. The company provides a monthly wellness stipend of \$75 that can be used for gym memberships, fitness classes, or mental health app subscriptions, reimbursed through the expense system. Northwind Robotics also offers an Employee Assistance Program (EAP) providing up to 6 free confidential counseling sessions per employee per year, available 24/7 through a third-party provider.

5. Expense Reimbursement Policy

Business-related expenses must be submitted through the Expensify system within 30 days of the expense being incurred; expenses submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed except in extraordinary circumstances approved by Finance. Any single expense over \$150 requires a manager's pre-approval before the purchase is made. Meal expenses while traveling on company business are capped at \$60 per day domestically and \$90 per day internationally. Airfare must be booked in economy class for flights under 6 hours; business class is permitted for flights exceeding 6 hours with director-level approval or higher. Reimbursements are processed on a bi-weekly basis, on the same schedule as payroll.

6. Equipment and IT Policy

All new employees are issued a company laptop within their first 3 business days. Engineering employees receive a laptop with a minimum of 32GB RAM; all other roles receive a standard 16GB configuration. Employees may request an equipment refresh every 3 years, or sooner if a device fails and cannot be repaired. Lost or stolen company equipment must be reported to the IT Security team within 24 hours of discovery. Installing unauthorized third-party software on company laptops is prohibited without prior approval from IT Security. All company laptops are enrolled in mobile device management (MDM) and are remotely wipeable in the event of loss, theft, or employee offboarding.

7. Code of Conduct and Anti-Harassment Policy

Northwind Robotics maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, discrimination, and retaliation of any kind. Employees who witness or experience a violation of this policy are encouraged to report it to their manager, any member of People Operations, or through the anonymous ethics hotline available at ethics.northwindrobotics.example. All reports are investigated within 10 business days of being received. Retaliation against an employee for making a good-faith report is itself grounds for termination. Confidentiality is maintained to the extent possible during an investigation, consistent with the need to conduct a thorough and fair

review.

8. Performance Review Process

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice a year, in June and December. Each review cycle includes a self-assessment, peer feedback from 2-4 colleagues selected by the employee and manager jointly, and a manager evaluation. Employees are rated on a 5-point scale ranging from "Does Not Meet Expectations" to "Significantly Exceeds Expectations." Compensation adjustments and promotions are considered during the December review cycle only, based on the prior 12 months of performance. Employees who receive a rating of "Does Not Meet Expectations" are placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) lasting 60 days, with a follow-up review at the end of that period.

9. Data Security and Confidentiality Policy

All employees must complete mandatory security awareness training within their first 2 weeks of employment and annually thereafter. Access to customer data is granted on a least-privilege, role-based basis and is reviewed quarterly by the Security team. Employees must use multi-factor authentication (MFA) for all company systems, including email, source control, and cloud infrastructure. Any suspected data breach or security incident must be reported to security@northwindrobotics.example within 1 hour of discovery. Confidential company information, including source code, customer lists, and unreleased product designs, may not be shared outside the company without written authorization from the employee's Vice President.

10. Resignation and Termination Policy

Employees voluntarily resigning are asked to provide a minimum of 2 weeks' written notice; engineering managers and above are asked to provide 4 weeks' notice to allow for knowledge transfer. Final paychecks, including any unused accrued PTO payout, are issued within 10 business days of the last working day, or sooner where required by local law. Company equipment must be returned on or before the last working day. Employees terminated for cause forfeit any unused PTO payout in states where this is legally permitted. Exit interviews are offered, but not mandatory, for all departing employees and are conducted by a People Operations representative who is not the employee's direct manager.